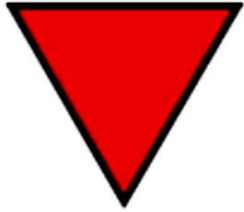


Writing a 5 paragraph Essay

Essay Format, Introductions, Body, Conclusions, Thesis Statements, and
Topic Sentences

Introduction

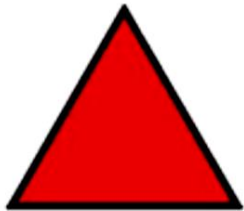


Thesis statement

Body of Essay



Rephrased thesis statement



Conclusion

Essay Format

- **Paragraph 1-** Introduction which includes a "hook statement", a lead-in /link to the essay topic, and the thesis statement.
- **Paragraphs 2, 3, and 4-** support your topic with detail paragraphs.
- **Paragraph 5 -** the conclusion statement that restates your thesis statement.

Introductory Paragraph

- ✓ First part of an essay
- ✓ Try to capture the reader's attention

Introduction Format

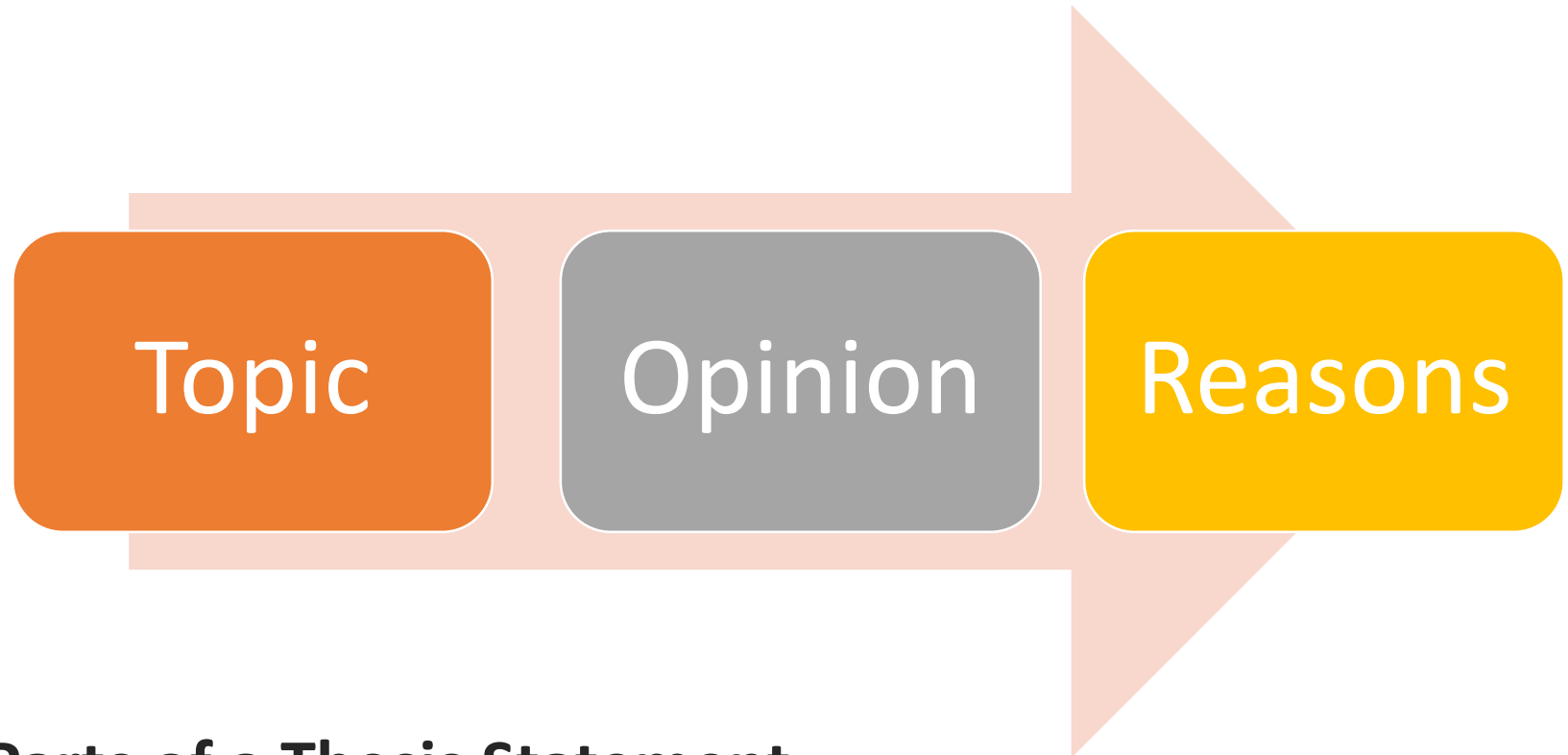
1. Attention getter or Reader's Hook
2. Bridge or transition sentences
3. Thesis statement (always at the end)

Ways to Start Your Introduction

Type of Reader's Hook	Example
Ask a rhetorical question	A rhetorical question is asked merely for effect with no answer expected. The answer may be obvious or immediately provided by the writer.
State a surprising fact or a puzzling statement	a completely unexpected occurrence, appearance, or statement: Vegans are the healthiest group of people in the world.
Start with a short story/anecdote	Some of my favorite childhood memories revolve around the time I spent helping my mother plant and tend a vegetable garden in our backyard. She let me help till the rows and plant the seeds. Going near okra plants made her itch, so she let me pick all of that myself. To this day, okra makes me

Introduction and Thesis Statement

- Make a link to connect the attention getting sentence(s) to your thesis statement Common way to make a link is to explain why the topic is important. This is often a few sentences long.
- Conclude introductory paragraph with the most important idea of the essay-**THE THESIS STATEMENT**



The Parts of a Thesis Statement

The Function of a Thesis Statement

To announce the topic to the reader

To reflect a judgment about the topic

To provide the reader with a blueprint
of what is to come in the paper

Example Introduction

Gnome-Phobia in America

(1) In 2004, the Gnome Liberation Front (GLF) was created. This group of people believes that gnomes should be free, not prisoners of their owner's garden. The GLF has now begun gnome-napping, the act of stealing gnomes and "freeing them" in the wilderness; however, the law is unwilling to do anything. (2). Many police state that the gnomes are not a serious enough offense to deal with and that they have larger crimes to deal with. This is not acceptable. The law should be taking the gnome-napping more seriously because people are committing a crime. (3). Gnome-napping is stealing personal property, and is illegal, morally wrong, and disrespectful.

1. Attention getter/Reader's Hook
2. Bridge/link or transition sentences
3. Thesis statement

****NOTE:** This doesn't mean your intro is 3 sentences long. It just has 3 parts.

The Body (paragraph 2-3 &4)

The body is a set of paragraphs that develop the idea expressed in the thesis statement.

- ✓ Make a list of main ideas that support the thesis statement. Each main idea becomes the main idea sentence for a body paragraph.
- ✓ Arrange the main ideas in logical order (time, place, importance)
- ✓ Plan out each body paragraph by listing major details that support each main idea
- ✓ Order the details within each paragraph in a logical way. Each body paragraph may end with a concluding sentence.
- After planning and arranging your main ideas and major details, begin writing your body paragraphs.
- Usually a short essay contains 3 paragraphs, plus an introduction and conclusion
- Remember to use signal words to make smooth transitions between sentences and paragraphs.

Example Essay Outline

Thesis Statement

Gnome-napping is stealing personal property, and is illegal, morally wrong, and disrespectful.

Body Paragraph 1

Topic Sentence: Gnome-napping is stealing someone's personal property, and stealing is illegal.

Main Points: 1.
 2.
 3.

Body Paragraph 2

Topic Sentence: It is morally wrong to take anyone's property, whether it is a gnome or a car.

Body Paragraph 3

Topic Sentence: The GLF is incredibly disrespectful because they take items that don't belong them.

Signal/Transition Words

For examples: For example, for instance, to illustrate

For organization or chronological order: The six steps are..., next, finally first, secondly, third

For additional points: Furthermore, in addition, also, moreover

For opposing ideas: On the other hand, in contrast, although, however

For similar ideas: Likewise, similarly, in comparison

For exceptions: However, nevertheless, but, yet, still

For emphasis: Above all, finally, more importantly

For understanding: In other words, in essence, briefly

For summarizing: In conclusion, to sum up, for these reasons, in a nutshell

Conclusion

- ✓ Leave the reader thinking about your topic. Leave an impression on them!
- ✓ No new information in conclusion
- ✓ Be sure to recap your ideas
- ✓ Should follow logically from the body of the essay
- ✓ Restate your thesis statement in different words
- ✓ You might want to have your reader do something after reading (“call to action” – Example: Go write your Senator about this problem.)

Sample Conclusion

Thesis
statement
rephrased.

Sample Conclusion

My experience will stay with me long after I head back to school and spend my wages on books and beer. The things that factory work has taught me – how lucky I am to get an education, how to work hard, how easy it is to lose that work once you have it – are by no means earth-shattering. Everyone has to come to grips with them at some point. How and when I learned these lessons, however, has inspired me to make the most of my college years before I enter the real world for good. Until then, the summer months I spend in the factories will be long, tiring and every bit as educational as a French-lit class.

Adapted from "Some Lessons from the Assembly Line" by Andrew Brassksma in *Steps to Writing Well with Additional Readings*. |

Summary of the main
ideas conveyed
throughout the paper.

Significance of the
points made
throughout the
essay.